

ENGLISH
TOPIC EXAM
EHSTT01-A

- 1) Who is the first character to see the Ghost in the play?
 - a) Hamlet
 - b) Horatio
 - c) Bernardo
 - d) Claudius
- 2) What is the name of Hamlet's close friend from Wittenberg?
 - a) Laertes
 - b) Rosencrantz
 - c) Horatio
 - d) Marcellus
- 3) What does Hamlet ask the travelling players to perform?
 - a) The Mousetrap
 - b) The Murder of Gonzago
 - c) Titus and Andronicus
 - d) The Jew of Malta
- 4) Who says "Something is rotten in the state of Denmark"?
 - a) Hamlet
 - b) Horatio
 - c) Marcellus
 - d) Francisco
- 5) "To be or not to be" appears in which Act and Scene traditionally?
 - a) Act I Scene ii
 - b) Act II Scene ii
 - c) Act III Scene i
 - d) Act IV Scene v
- 6) Hamlet returns to Denmark from England because:
 - a) Claudius summons him
 - b) He defeats England
 - c) Pirates intervene his ship
 - d) Ghost calls him back
- 7) What literary device dominates Hamlet's soliloquies?
 - a) Synecdoche
 - b) Metaphysical wit
 - c) Metaphor and antithesis
 - d) Chiasmus only
- 8) "Madness" in Hamlet is primarily used as:
 - a) Psychological realism
 - b) A forensic device to mislead enemies
 - c) Ritual initiation
 - d) Comic relief
- 9) Which critic called Hamlet "a failure of the poet"?
 - a) Dr. Johnson
 - b) T. S. Eliot
 - c) Coleridge
 - d) A. C. Bradley
10. "...brevity is the soul of wit." This proverbial line from Hamlet is spoken by:
 - a) The Ghost
 - b) Horatio
 - c) Laertes
11. How was King Hamlet killed?
 - a) Claudius poisoned his wine
 - b) Claudius stabbed him
 - c) He was killed by the Norwegian army
 - d) Claudius poured poison in his ear
12. How many characters die during the course of the play Hamlet?
 - a) Nine
 - b) Eight
 - c) Seven
 - d) Five
11. Who is shipwrecked at the beginning of the play?
 - a) Viola
 - b) Sebastian
 - c) Both Viola and Sebastian
 - d) Antoniod. Polonius
14. Olivia falls in love with —
 - a) Orsino
 - b) Sebastian
 - c) Cesario
 - d) Sir Andrew
15. The yellow stockings symbolize —
 - a) Love and joy
 - b) Foolishness and vanity
 - c) Mourning
 - d) Wealth
16. The "fool" in Shakespearean comedy often represents —
 - a) Hidden wisdom
 - b) Moral corruption
 - c) Tragic downfall
 - d) Comic relief only
17. "Some are born great, some achieve greatness..." is part of —
 - a) The forged letter
 - b) Feste's song
 - c) Orsino's speech
 - d) The recognition scene
18. The play ends with a song by —
 - a) Feste
 - b) Orsino
 - c) Viola
 - d) Olivia

19. Twelfth Night shares themes of mistaken identity with —
 a) Hamlet b) Macbeth c) The Tempest d) The Comedy of Errors
20. The name “Malvolio” literally means —
 a) Ill-will b) Happy fool c) Pure-hearted d) Meloncholy
21. A–R: (A) Viola’s disguise creates dramatic irony.
 (R) The audience knows she is female while characters do not.
 a) Both true; R explains A b) Both true; R not explanation
 c) A true; R false d) A false; R true
22. A–R: (A) Feste serves as a truth-teller.
 (R) His songs and jests often expose characters’ self-deceptions.
 a) Both true; R explains A b) Both true; R not explanation
 c) A true; R false d) A false; R true
23. Who calls Sir Toby a “coxcomb”?
 a) Malvolio b) Sir Andrew c) Feste d) Fabian
24. Which line belongs to Feste?
 a) “Youth’s a stuff will not endure.” b) “The rest is silence.”
 c) “We are such stuff as dreams are made on.” d) “Tomorrow, and tomorrow, and tomorrow—”
25. A–R: (A) Olivia punishes Malvolio for his insolence.
 (R) She commits him to the madhouse personally.
 a) Both true; R explains A b) Both true; R not explanation
 c) A true; R false d) A false; R true
26. Identify the correct statement
 I. Maria writes the forged letter. II. Fabian objects to the prank.
 III. Sir Toby encourages the prank. IV. Malvolio suspects a trick from the start.
 a) I & III only b) I, II, III only c) II, IV only d) I, III, IV only
27. The word sonnet comes from the Italian ‘sonetto’ that means:
 a) great song b) little song c) love song d) solo song
28. The rhyme scheme of Sonnet 18 is —
 a) ABBA ABBA CDC DCD b) ABAB CDCD EFEF GG
 c) AABB CCDD EEFF GG d) ABAB BCBC CDCD EE
29. The sonnet 18 belongs to which sub-sequence?
 a) Dark Lady sonnets b) Rival poet sonnets c) Fair Youth sonnets d) Sonnets of absence
30. In Sonnet 18, “every fair from fair sometime declines” states that —
 a) moral principles decay b) beauty is subject to temporality
 c) nature fails by divine decree d) death is voluntary
31. (Assertion–Reason)
 A: The beloved in Sonnet 18 is declared “more lovely and more temperate.”
 R: Nature possesses stable and evenly-distributed conditions in summer.
 a) A and R true, R explains A b) A true, R false
 c) A false, R true d) Both false
32. The “eye of heaven” refers to —
 a) God b) The beloved’s eyes
 c) The sun d) The moon
33. “Rough winds do shake the darling buds of May” uses
 a) Metonymy b) Personification c) Litotes d) Synecdoche
34. So long lives this” — “this” most directly means
 a) Love itself b) The season c) The poem/text d) The beloved’s portrait

35. The poem's (Sonnet 18) logical progression is
- Praise '! complaint '! satire
 - Question '! reasons of inadequacy '! promise of immortality
 - Narrative '! dialogue '! epilogue
 - Lament '! elegy '! epitaph
36. Which line best marks the volta?
- "Rough winds do shake..."
 - "But thy eternal summer shall not fade"
 - "Too hot the eye of heaven shines"
 - "Every fair from fair sometime declines"
37. The poem (Sonnet 18) most strongly evokes which classical idea?
- Utopia
 - The power of art to memorialize (monumentum aere perennius)
 - Stoic apatheia
 - Platonic cave
38. The dominant tone in the opening quatrain of Sonnet 30 is
- Anger
 - Nostalgic sorrow
 - Joyful pride
 - Ironic detachment
39. The sonnet 30 is predominantly about
- Poverty and material loss
 - Memory and emotional accounting
 - Nature's mutability
 - Artistic inspiration
40. The volta (turn in sense) typically arrives in
- Line 9
 - Line 12
 - Line 13
 - Line 14
41. The rhetorical movement of the poem goes from
- Joy '! Sorrow
 - Complaint '! Consolation
 - Action '! Inaction
 - Doubt '! Faith
42. In Sonnet 116, Shakespeare defines true love by contrasting it with
- Lust and appetite
 - Legal marriage
 - Change and circumstance
 - Death and eternity
43. The sonnet 116 is structurally a
- Petrarchan sonnet
 - Spenserian sonnet
 - Shakespearean sonnet
 - Miltonic sonnet
44. Time in the poem Sonnet 116 is personified as
- A judge
 - A farmer with a sickle
 - A bridegroom
 - A philosopher
45. A: The poem Sonnet 116 is didactic because it corrects false conceptions of love.
R: It uses logical refutation to state what love is not.
- A and R true; R explains A
 - A true; R true but unrelated
 - A false; R true
 - Both false
46. The poem "Batter my heart" opens with the address to the
- Muse
 - Three-person'd God
 - Beloved mistress
 - Guardian angel
47. "Batter my heart" is commonly numbered among Donne's
- Songs and Sonnets
 - Holy Sonnets
 - Satires
 - Epigrams
48. The speaker asks God to "break, blow, and burn" in order to
- Punish his enemies
 - Reform/renew him
 - Grant worldly success
 - Avenge a betrayal
49. The poem's apostrophe is directed to
- Christ alone
 - God in Trinitarian unity
 - The Holy Spirit alone
 - The Virgin Mary
50. "Imprison me, for I / Except you enthrall me, never shall be free" primarily critiques
- Stoic autonomy
 - Scholastic logic
 - Humanist education
 - Monastic vows

51. The shift from “knock, breathe, shine” to “break, blow, burn” signals
- Consolation to despair
 - Mild to violent divine operations
 - Personal to public concerns
 - Epigram to satire
52. Match the domain to the phrase:
- | | | |
|----------------------|---|------------------------------|
| i) Siege warfare | — | a) “usurp’d town” |
| ii) Legal/marital | — | b) “betroth’d... divorce me” |
| iii) Bondage/freedom | — | c) “enthral me... free” |
| iv) Purge/reform | — | d) “break, blow, burn” |
- a) i-a, ii-b, iii-c, iv-d b) i-b, ii-a, iii-d, iv-c c) i-c, ii-d, iii-a, iv-b d) i-d, ii-c, iii-b, iv-a
53. The line “Your force to break, blow, burn, and make me new” contains which sound pattern most prominently?
- Assonance on “o”
 - Alliteration on “b”
 - Consonance on “k”
 - Rhyme-rich internal couplets
54. The sonnet “Batter my heart” most closely aligns with which spiritual sequence?
- Desolation ’! illumination ’! union
 - Sin’s bondage ’! divine assault ’! paradoxical freedom
 - Ethical deliberation ’! civic action ’! reward
 - Catechesis ’! confirmation ’! ordination
55. The opening line of “The Canonization” begins with a plea to
- The King
 - God
 - A friend/critic to be silent
 - His beloved to leave
56. The poem argues that the lovers should be canonized as
- Martyrs of war
 - Saints of love
 - Saints of charity
 - Saints of scholarship
57. The poet John Donne belongs to which school?
- Cavalier
 - Metaphysical
 - Romantic
 - Georgian
58. “What merchant’s ships have my sighs drown’d?” is an example of
- Hyperbole and rhetorical question
 - Literal description
 - Pastoral simile
 - Paradox only
59. The lovers are compared to a Phoenix to suggest
- Greed
 - Chastity
 - Rebirth and unity of two in one
 - Political ambition
60. Matching Conceit & Function
- | | | |
|----------------|---|---------------------------------|
| i) Phoenix | — | a) mystical union |
| ii) Tomb/relic | — | b) sainthood & veneration |
| iii) Tapers | — | c) devotion/illumination |
| iv) Fly | — | d) trivialization turned ironic |
- a) i-a, ii-b, iii-c, iv-d b) i-b, ii-a, iii-d, iv-c c) i-c, ii-d, iii-b, iv-a d) i-d, ii-c, iii-a, iv-b
61. The poem “Canonisation” has how many stanzas?
- Three
 - Four
 - Five
 - Six
62. The poem claims their love harms
- The exchequer
 - The town’s water supply
 - No one at all
 - The army
63. “Lycidas” is primarily a/an
- Pastoral elegy
 - Closet drama
 - Epic fragment
 - Sonnet sequence
64. The poem commemorates the death of
- Charles Diodati
 - Edward King
 - Henry Lawes
 - Richard Crashaw
65. Edward King died by
- Plague
 - Drowning at sea
 - Duel
 - War wounds

66. The speaker introduces himself as an
 a) "Uncouth swain" b) "Melancholy man" c) "Blind bard" d) "Rustic clown"
67. The river god "Camus" signifies
 a) Oxford's Isis b) Cambridge (River Cam)
 c) Severn's deity d) Tiber's genius
68. In pastoral convention, the dead youth is
 a) A king b) A shepherd/poet c) A merchant d) A soldier
69. "Next Camus, reverend sire, went footing slow" uses
 a) Allegoresis b) Prosopopoeia/personification
 c) Parabasis d) Zeugma
70. "The Herald of the Sea" (Triton) and other sea-powers appear in order to
 a) Celebrate naval victory b) Lament and testify to Lycidas' loss
 c) Debate theology d) Satirize sailors
71. The publication year of "Lycidas" is
 a) 1634 b) 1637 c) 1638 d) 1645
72. "Next Camus, reverend sire" alludes to Milton's own
 a) Oxford ties b) Cambridge affiliation
 c) Italian tour d) Parliamentary career
73. Paradise Lost Book 9 narrates primarily
 a) The Creation b) The Fall of Man c) The War in Heaven d) The Flood
74. The tempter in Book 9 appears as a
 a) Cherub b) Lion
 c) Serpent (inhabited by Satan) d) Dove
75. The book 9 of paradise lost opens with the poet announcing a change of tone to
 a) Comic b) Pastoral c) Tragic d) Satiric
76. Adam's initial response to Eve's proposal is to
 a) Forbid her absolutely b) Agree immediately
 c) Caution her but allow freedom d) Ignore her
77. The tree forbidden to Adam and Eve is the Tree of
 a) Life b) Knowledge of Good and Evil
 c) Virtue d) Liberty
78. To persuade Eve, the serpent chiefly uses
 a) Threats of force b) Bribes of gold
 c) Flattery and sophistry d) Scriptural citation
79. Immediately after eating, Adam and Eve experience
 a) Prophetic visions b) Lust and shame c) Angelic elevation d) Dreamless sleep
80. They cover their nakedness with
 a) Palm bark b) Fig-leaves sewn together
 c) Animal skins d) Ivy
81. Mac Flecknoe is a satire written by
 a) Pope b) Dryden c) Swift d) Rochester
82. The poem is directed primarily against
 a) Milton b) Shadwell c) Jonson d) Marvell
83. The title Mac Flecknoe implies Shadwell as
 a) Son/heir of Flecknoe in dulness b) Political rebel
 c) Royal poet d) Philanthropist

84. Richard Flecknoe was
 a) A celebrated epic poet
 b) A mediocre writer satirized by Dryden
 c) A dramatist in Milton's circle
 d) A philosopher
85. "Sh—— alone, of all my sons, is he" — Sh—— refers to
 a) Settle
 b) Shadwell
 c) Shaftesbury
 d) Sheridan
86. Shadwell was associated with which party circle?
 a) Tory
 b) Whig
 c) Jacobite
 d) Puritan
87. Dryden was Poet Laureate under
 a) Charles II
 b) Anne
 c) James II
 d) William
88. Dryden's method differs from Pope by
 a) Being earlier and more politically topical
 b) Being romantic and emotional
 c) Rejecting satire
 d) Being religious
89. Naming Flecknoe as progenitor links dullness with
 a) Apostolic discipline
 b) Succession rhetoric
 c) Economic theory
 d) Foreign invasion
90. "Shadwell never deviates into sense" is an example of
 a) Litotes
 b) Paradox
 c) Irony-hyperbole
 d) Metonymy
91. The opening time-setting of the Elegy is primarily
 a) Dawn
 b) Noon
 c) Evening/twilight
 d) Midnight
92. The "ivied" church and "yew-tree" primarily signal
 a) Growth and wealth
 b) Rural commerce
 c) Funereal stillness and tradition
 d) War and conquest
93. Gray's Elegy was first published in
 a) 1742
 b) 1751
 c) 1760
 d) 1770
94. "The paths of glory lead but to the grave" is an example of
 a) Paradox / gnomic sententia
 b) Liturgical refrain
 c) Blazon
 d) Oxymoron only
95. "Their lot forbade" chiefly refers to
 a) Legal banishment
 b) Providential and social constraints
 c) Religious excommunication
 d) Voluntary silence
96. Which couple best sums the poem's governing contrasts?
 a) City vs. country
 b) Fame vs. obscurity; ambition vs. humility
 c) War vs. peace
 d) Youth vs. age only
97. The "hoary-headed swain" functions as
 a) Judge
 b) Witness-narrator within the poem's frame
 c) Comic foil
 d) Sexton only
98. PM SHRI stands for:
 a) Pradhan Mantri School for Holistic Research Initiative
 b) Prime Minister's Scheme for Higher Research Institutions
 c) Pradhan Mantri Schools for Rising India
 d) Public Model Schools for Rural India
99. PM SHRI scheme aims to develop how many schools across India?
 a) 1,000
 b) 10,000
 c) 14,500
 d) 50,000
100. The Nobel Prize in Literature 2025 was awarded to —
 a) Can Xue
 b) Annie Ernaux
 c) Jon Fosse
 d) Salman Rushdie